M11 Diphenhydramine

Scope of Practice	EMT
Classification	• Antihistamine
Usual Presentation	• 50mg/1ml vial
Mechanism of Action	• Blocks the action of histamine at H1 receptors reducing histamine induced symptoms (such as itching, urticaria and edema)
Indications	• Moderate to Severe Allergic Reactions / Anaphylaxis.
Contraindications	• Known allergy • Lactation • Children less than 4 weeks
Precautions	• Nil
Side Effects	• Drowsiness / CNS depression • Pain associated with IV injection.
Adult Dose & Administration	• 1mg/kg IM/IV (maximum 50mg) • IM administration is preferred. • For IV administration, dilute in 100ml Normal Saline and administer as an infusion over 5 minutes.
Pediatric Dose & Administration	• 1mg/kg IM/IV (maximum 50mg) • IM administration is preferred. • For IV administration, dilute in 1ml/kg of Normal Saline and administer as an infusion over 5 minutes.
Use in Pregnancy and Lactation	• Pregnancy: Fetal harm has been demonstrated. Should not be routinely administered in pregnancy. • Lactation: Safety has not been established. Should not be routinely administered in lactation.
Additional Information	• IV administration is highly associated with pain at the injection site – avoid undiluted administration.